By AMIT PASRICHA
Panoramic photographer; Founder, India Lost and Found project





INDIA PICTURE

Master your Lenses

A top photographer trains his eye on the country's most photogenic beauty spots

Garli

It's a small village in Himachal Pradesh where the Beas River meets the plains. This village was set up by the Sood clan; in fact, it's right next to Pragpur, another place one should visit. Garli has these old homes with slate shingles, *jaali* brickwork and remnants of Belgian glass chandeliers. Each home is built in its own individualistic style; some of them are like a chateau, all with beautiful brickwork, worth capturing on camera. Several houses have been locked up and left to decay by the owners. But do walk around and get some nice photographs as Garli is really picturesque.



Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

Kapurthala

What makes Kapurthala in Punjab remarkable is all the French architecture; it had about seven palaces, some of which have been demolished. The Jagatjit Palace is the largest but difficult to access as it's also the Sainik School. Some are quite decrepit and threatened by the possibility of demolition, such as the Lal Kothi and the Jalli Kothi. But the place that will take your breath away is the Moorish Mosque, an immaculate and well-maintained structure. There are some lovely havelis in town, and even the Shalimar Bagh with its memorials is worth exploring with your lens.

Chanderi

This remarkable town in Madhya Pradesh is home to the Chanderi saree. As you wander around town, you encounter homes where entire families are busy weaving these exquisite sarees. Don't miss the opportunity to capture these skilled artisans at the loom. Then there's the Chanderi Fort and below it an amazing gate called the Badal Mahal, which really doesn't lead anywhere, but is beautifully carved.